point to prove. We made a slow start but caught on after the New Zealand match, thanks to Umar Gul's magical spell and my crazy catch in that semi-final (running backwards at what felt like 100 mph, I felt like the world was ours to conquer).

And then I asked our captain, Younis Khan, if I could bat up the order.

I did so not for mere victory. I had a larger goal: I wanted to take more responsibility. It was important to comprehensively clinch the semi-final against South Africa – we knew that we had a chance against them; we knew that in crucial knock-out games they had earned a reputation of being 'chokers'. That's why I asked to bat up the order: to change our approach, our strategy, and to create unexpected pressure on their bowlers. That's why that particular match will always go down as one where I didn't play like myself. We knew that the semi-final was more important than the final. Once we advanced from the semis, we were confident that that momentum would allow us to win the final. So it was our motivation and determination to make things right and it helped our cause.

I liked those early days of Younis Khan's captaincy. He is a democrat. He dealt with all players equally – that was his strength and wisdom. Although not a natural at leading a side, just like he wasn't a naturally gifted cricketer, he had the ability to handle us according to our individual sensitivities and whims. As a result, the mood in the Pakistan dressing room in those days became rather congenial. The World T20 victory helped, with us flattening the Lankans and lifting the trophy so soon after we had experienced the trauma of the Lahore attack.

But the gloomy legacy of the Pakistan team – much like the country it represents – is its inability to fight its inner battles.

Soon after that tournament, Younis bhai's captaincy unravelled and things really started disintegrating. The era of politics and infighting that followed eventually led to one of the darkest periods in Pakistan cricket.